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Procurement without the pauses

How developers fast-track supplier choice, contracts and the lender pack, onshore and offshore, with the team they have

Procurement starts before the win, while every hour is development money at risk. After the win, every week a pack waits is lost.

Process first, data second, agents third: how one record and a team of agents take a project from tender to financial close without stopping at each gate.

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Not legal, regulatory or investment advice.

00 AT A GLANCE

Most procurement time is lost between the gates, not inside them.

FIVE MESSAGES FOR YOUR LEADERSHIP TEAM

1. **Procurement starts before the win.** Until award, the time spent on suppliers is development money at risk. Do it once, on one record, so it feeds the bid and then the tender.
2. **Winning starts the clock; the pauses sit between gates.** Packages redrawn, questions asked twice and a lender pack rebuilt at the end, while milestones keep running.
3. **Process first, data second, agents third.** Map how you procure today, fix the two biggest pauses and their causes, build one record, then add agents.
4. **One record, every document.** Comparison, contract, model and lender pack read the same facts, so nothing is retyped and nothing drifts.
5. **Build your own system, and own it.** You can buy a platform, or build your own. We help you build your own, on your data. Your people negotiate, allocate risk and sign.

Who this paper is for

CEOs and heads of procurement, commercial and development at renewables developers, IPPs and utilities in the UK and Europe, onshore and offshore.

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7 gates, 1 record

From package strategy to financial close. Agents keep the next gate ready, so the project does not stop between them.

> "The challenge is no longer building agents. It's building the system behind them."
>
> The Ignis view

01 WHY NOW

The clocks run while documents wait

Once a project wins its route to market, three clocks start at once: the support contract, the grid and the supply chain. None of them pauses for a tender pack sitting in someone's inbox.

18 months

After signing a UK CfD, the generator must show spend of at least 10% of pre-commissioning costs, or the required project commitments.

90 days

To accept a GB transmission connection offer once it arrives.

Up to 4 years

To secure large power transformers. Cables take two to three years, and lead times have almost doubled since 2021.

When costs outrun the project

In July 2023 Vattenfall stopped developing Norfolk Boreas in its current form, citing cost increases of up to 40%.

In May 2025 Ørsted stopped Hornsea 4 in its current form after winning a CfD in 2024. Its chief executive pointed to "the combination of increased supply chain costs, higher interest rates and increased execution risk".

Neither was a paperwork problem. Both show how little room there is between award and investment decision.

Procurement now feeds the bid

Under the EU Net-Zero Industry Act, the ability to deliver on time is a test to qualify for renewables auctions, and resilience can be scored. Supplier evidence is no longer only for lenders. It goes into the round itself.

Onshore and offshore alike: the packages differ in size and number. Both lose the same weeks between gates.

THE IGNIS VIEW

Policy, grid, the supply chain and lenders each move on their own calendar, and projects stall in the gaps between them. The industry needs coordination from policy and regulation through to the industrial plan. Inside the developer the same rule applies: start procurement before the round is won, and keep every gate ready before the last one closes.



02 WHERE PROCUREMENT WAITS

Seven gates, and the pauses between them

Drawn as a plan, procurement is a line of gates. In practice much of the elapsed time sits in the gaps, where work waits for a decision or is redone because something upstream changed.

THE SAME SEVEN GATES, RUN TWO WAYS | IGNIS VIEW

TODAY: EACH GATE WAITS FOR THE LAST ONE TO FINISH



1. Design not frozen, so packages are redrawn
2. Scope rewritten for the tender documents
3. The same questions asked by every bidder
4. Offers arrive in different shapes and scopes
5. The model and the draft contract drift apart
6. Due diligence starts from a blank folder

Pauses and gaps: work stops, or is redone, while the next gate gets ready.

WITH ONE RECORD AND AGENTS: THE NEXT GATE IS READY BEFORE THIS ONE CLOSES



Agents prepare the next pack in parallel; people decide at each gate

One project record underneath every gate

Scope, packages, offers, clarifications, model inputs, contract terms and lender answers, versioned and owned

What stays the same

The gates, the decisions and the people who take them. Shortlist, preferred bidder, risk allocation and signature stay with your team and your board.

What changes

The next pack is drafted while this gate is decided. Nothing is retyped. A change is approved once and reaches every document that uses it.

Find your own pauses in an afternoon

Take one package you closed last year. Put the date each gate opened and closed on one line. The gaps between them are your pauses. For the two longest, ask what the team was waiting for, and whether it had to wait.



02 EARLY PROCUREMENT, BEFORE GATE 1

Procurement starts before the round is won

Before award nothing is secured, and every hour spent on suppliers is development money at risk. Yet the bid needs supplier evidence: prices, lead times and the ability to deliver. Done once, on one record, early procurement feeds the bid and becomes the first tender pack.

1 Sound the market

A long list of suppliers per package, with capacity, lead times and delivery slots for the target year.

2 Indicative prices into the floor price

Current supplier prices and dates feed the capex and the floor price, not last year's numbers.

3 Evidence the round can score

Delivery, resilience and sustainability evidence gathered once, for the round and later for lenders.

4 A draft package strategy

Packages, interfaces and the contracting approach sketched, so gate 1 opens with a draft, not a blank page.

What agents carry

- Supplier long lists and market notes, kept current.
- Questions to suppliers logged, so none is asked twice before and after award.
- Indicative prices and dates linked to the bid model.

What your people decide

- How much to spend before award, project by project.
- Which suppliers to engage, and on what terms.
- The capex and dates the bid rests on.

THE IGNIS VIEW

Early procurement often draws in people from technical, commercial and finance teams, and much of it is redone after award. Make it lighter and reusable, and the same development budget carries more projects to the round, with better evidence in each bid.

> Spend less to learn more before award. Then start gate 1 from what you already know.

03 PROCESS FIRST

First, look at what you run today

The first step is not a tool. It is a clear look at how your team takes a package from strategy to signature, where it waits, and why.

1 Offers that are not the same offer

Each bidder prices a slightly different scope, so the cheapest offer is often the one that left most out.

Fix: restate every offer onto one scope before anyone ranks it.

2 Questions asked and answered twice

Clarifications sit in email threads, and the same question comes back from each bidder.

Fix: one clarification log, answered once and shared.

3 A model that is not the contract

Price, indexation and caps move in negotiation; the financial model catches up later.

Fix: model and draft read the same terms, and a change needs an approval.

4 Dates that do not agree

The grid date, the CfD milestone and the supplier's programme live in three places.

Fix: one date register with one owner, checked at every gate.

5 The lender pack built at the end

Due diligence starts from a blank folder, months after the evidence was first gathered.

Fix: build the pack as you go, from the record.

Start with two

Pick the two pauses that cost you most, and find the reason for each. Fix those first. The rest can wait.

THE ORDER THAT WORKS

1 **Process first**

What do you run today? Map one package from strategy to signature. Remove steps that add nothing. Simplify what is left.

2 **Data second**

What does it run on? One record per project: scope, offers, terms, dates and evidence, versioned and owned.

3 **Agents third**

Then add the agents, on the redesigned process, with named people deciding at each gate.

Revisit the real problem first

Why does a tender take as long as it does? Which steps exist because a lender or a rule needs them, and which because "we have always done it"? Is the package split right for this market? Automate a broken process and you get a faster broken process.

04 COMPARING SUPPLIERS LIKE FOR LIKE

Compare like for like before you rank

Ranking offers that answer different scopes is really ranking scopes. Restate every offer onto one grid first, and the real differences show up in days rather than in the final week.

HOW A LIKE-FOR-LIKE GRID READS | A FRAMEWORK, NOT A REAL TENDER

Line	Supplier A	Supplier B	Supplier C	What the agent raises
Scope and interfaces	Same	**Gap**	Same	B leaves out one interface
Exclusions	Same	Same	**Ask**	C has not stated them
Programme against grid date	Same	**Gap**	Same	B misses the connection date
Price and indexation	Same	**Ask**	Same	Restated onto one index
Delay damages and caps	Same	Same	**Gap**	Below your last agreed position
Warranties and availability	Same	Same	**Gap**	Shorter term offered
Security and credit	Same	Excluded	Same	No parent guarantee
Resilience and supply chain	Same	**Ask**	Same	Evidence the bid and lenders need

Same: matches the tender scope. **Gap:** differs and changes the price. **Ask:** unclear, goes to the clarification log. **Excluded:** not offered.

What agents carry

- Read every offer and map it onto the grid.
- Flag gaps, exclusions and dates that miss the grid.
- Draft clarifications and log each answer once.
- Restate prices onto one index and one scope.

What your people decide

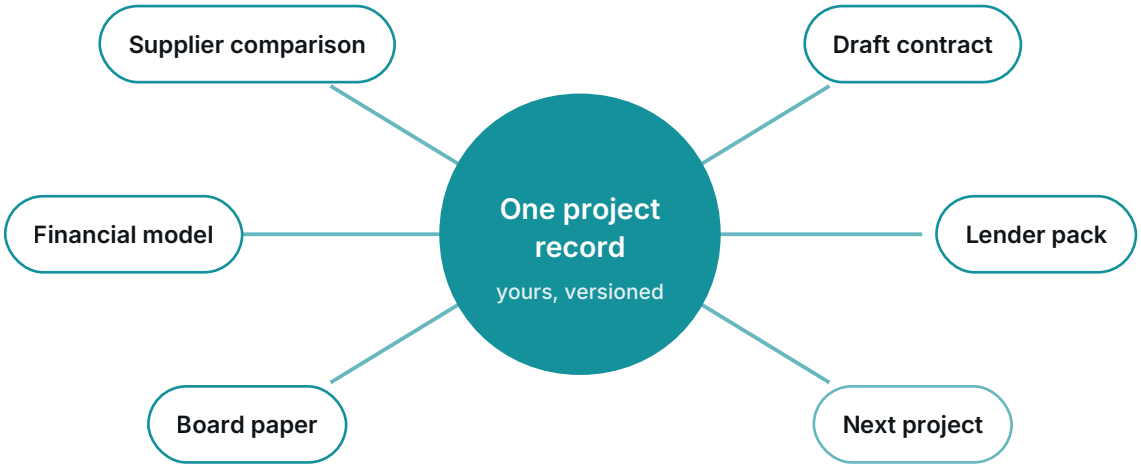
- Which gaps matter, and what they are worth.
- The shortlist and the preferred bidder.
- Where to push and where to concede.
- Supplier relationships and the final call.

Onshore and offshore: offshore runs fewer, larger packages with long supplier lists for each; onshore runs more, smaller packages, often several projects at once. The grid works for both, and the record keeps every past offer for the next tender.

04 CONTRACT AND LENDER PACK

Contract and lender pack, from one record

The comparison, the contract, the model and the lender pack describe the same project. When they read from one record, a change made in negotiation reaches all of them, with a name and a date on it.



What has to agree before signature

Item	Comparison	Contract	Model and lender pack
Scope	The restated scope	Scope of works	Capex and contingency
Price	Restated price	Contract price and indexation	Capex and cost case
Dates	Programme against grid	Key dates and delay damages	Schedule and milestone tests
Risk	Gaps and exclusions	Caps, warranties, security	Risk register and downside case

Approve changes, do not email them. A price, date or risk moves only with a named approval on the record. The consistency check runs before every gate.

Lenders ask the same questions. Keep every question and answer from the last close, and the next data room starts half built.

05 SAME TEAM, MORE OUTPUT

The same team, more output, better quality

The aim is not fewer people. It is more packages, bidders and questions handled well by the people you have, with fewer errors reaching a lender.

MORE

Quantity

- More packages run in parallel.
- More bidders assessed properly, not cut early for lack of time.
- The next gate ready on the day this one closes.

BETTER

Quality

- Every number traced to its source.
- Model, contract and pack in step.
- Terms won and conceded kept for the next project.

Who does what

Role	Agents carry	Your people keep
Head of procurement	Tender packs, the bidder log, the comparison grid	Package strategy, shortlist, supplier relationships
Commercial lead	First mark-up from your last agreed terms	Risk allocation and the negotiation
Finance and funding	Model updates, consistency checks, lender answers	The financing case and lender relationships
Technical lead	Interface and programme checks against the grid date	Design choices and technical sign-off
CEO and board	A board paper from the record, with the open risks	The investment decision and the signature

> People keep the judgement and the relationships. Agents carry the reading, the logs and the first drafts.



06 INSIDE THE SYSTEM

A governed system on your data, better with every project

Ignis builds the system around your team, on your own documents and in your own environment. It keeps the record, runs the repeatable work and brings every decision to a named person.

People and gates
Shortlist, preferred bidder, risk allocation, sign-off. Named people decide at each gate.

AI manager: plans the work, routes it to agents, checks it, brings each decision to a person

AGENTS

Tender pack
Packages and scope drawn from the record

Clarifications
Logged, routed and answered once

Comparison
Every offer restated like for like

Mark-up
First draft from the last agreed terms

Consistency
Model, contract and pack agree

Due diligence
Lender questions answered from the record

CONNECTORS TO THE TOOLS YOU ALREADY USE

Tender portal | Financial model | Document store | Data room | Email, calendar

Your data and context: one record, owned by you, that improves with every project

- Project facts: scope, dates, grid, consents
- Offers, clarifications and decisions
- Past contracts: terms won and conceded
- Lender questions and answers

Governance

Named gates

Audit trail

Access rules

Your environment

The AI manager

Breaks a goal such as "turbine supply to preferred bidder" into tasks, gives each to the right agent, checks the output and stops at each gate for a decision.

The record is yours

Offers, terms, dates and lender answers stay in your environment under your access rules. Each project leaves it better for the next.

What stays human

The shortlist, the preferred bidder, risk allocation, the walk-away and the signature. Supplier and lender relationships.

Supplier prices stay confidential, and you can prove it

Offers, prices and terms stay in your environment. You decide where the models run and what they can read, and every read, change and approval leaves an audit trail you can show suppliers, partners and lenders.

Buy a platform, or build your own

Platforms are quick to start and suit standard tasks. Supplier terms and lessons are your edge, so we help you build your own: a governed system on your data, handed over to your team.

07 SELF-CHECK

How fast can your next package move?

Ten yes or no questions. Tick what is true today, not what is planned.

- ☐ Package strategy starts before the round result, not after it
- ☐ We know where our pauses between gates are, and roughly how long each lasts
- ☐ Every offer is restated onto one scope before it is ranked
- ☐ Clarifications sit in one log, answered once and shared
- ☐ The grid date, the CfD milestone and supplier programmes sit in one date register
- ☐ The financial model reads the same terms as the draft contract
- ☐ A price, date or risk changes only with a named approval on the record
- ☐ The lender pack is built as we go, not at the end
- ☐ Terms won and conceded on the last contract are where the next one starts
- ☐ We have mapped one package end to end and know its two biggest pain points

Score: 0 to 3, start with the process map and a date register. 4 to 7, build the comparison grid and the one record, then add agents. 8 to 10, you are ready to run more packages with the same team.

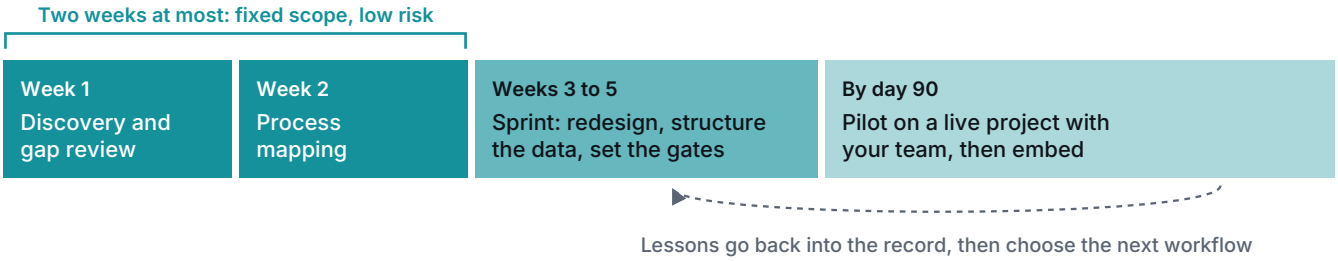
Work it out on your own numbers

For one project	Today	Redesigned	What it frees
Packages in procurement this year			
Days waiting between gates, in total			
Senior days per supplier comparison			
Lender questions answered from scratch			

08 WHERE TO START

Start with your two biggest pauses

Not with a platform. First comes a short, low-risk discovery and gap review, then a map of one package from strategy to signature: two weeks at most.



WEEK 1

Discovery and gap review

Your goals, your package plan, and the two biggest pauses in procurement, with their causes.

WEEK 2

Process mapping

One recent package traced end to end on its own documents. What people keep, what agents carry, where the gates sit.

WEEKS 3 TO 5

Sprint

Redesign the process, build the comparison grid and the record, and set the gates for the next live package.

BY DAY 90

Pilot

Your team runs a live tender on the new way of working, then embeds it.

Start with a discovery: two weeks at most, for a clear view of where agents will help.

Discovery and gap review, then process mapping

Guardrails

- Ignis advises and designs; your team decides.
- Your data stays yours, in your environment.
- Process before platform: tool-agnostic.
- Your system, handed over to your team.

Want to talk through your procurement?

Bring one project heading for preferred bidder or financial close. We will look at where it waits today and what would change first. Talk it through with Yorik: **ignisleadership.com/contact**

+ NEXT READS AND ABOUT IGNIS

ALL STAGES

Agentic transformation for energy developers

The practical guide to introducing agents, from early stage development to financial close.

ROUTE TO MARKET

Choose your route to market, then win it

CfD rounds, merchant, corporate PPAs and private wire, and how to win the round.

WEEKLY

Signal, the newsletter

What is moving on the road to financial close. ignisleadership.com/insights

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About Ignis

Ignis Leadership is an advisory practice for onshore and offshore renewables developers, IPPs and utilities across the UK and Europe. We help teams win the right to develop and move projects to financial close, with fewer delays, fewer surprises and stronger terms. Expert-led, AI-assisted, on your data.

About Yorik Tisseau

Founder of Ignis Leadership. Yorik has worked in onshore and offshore renewables since 2013, from early stage development to financial close.

Talk it through with Yorik:
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Disclaimer. This paper offers a commercial view only. It is not legal, regulatory or investment advice. Market figures were checked in October 2026; contract terms and dates can change.